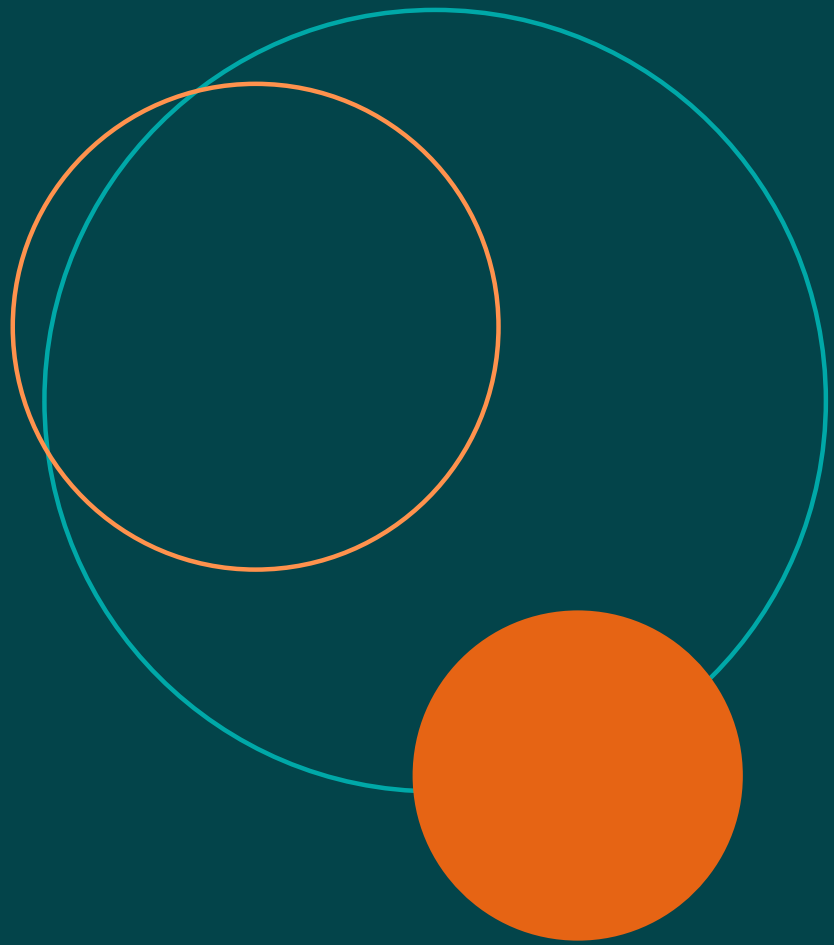
WHAT THE KIDS ACTUALLY NEED · SESSION 3 OF 6 · LIVE

Turning Insight Into Words

Building Your Exchanges

Friday, November 6 · 12:00 PM Pacific



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WHERE WE LEFT OFF

From the soil test to the recipe

LAST TIME: THE SOIL TEST

- Nine numbers about your child's temperament
- Where your plot and theirs overlap
- Field notes, not a report card

TODAY: THE RECIPE

- A small, specific plan for one moment
- What is going on in this child
- What you will say and what you will do

An exchange is any handoff between two homes. A recipe is the plan for one of them.

Same promise as last time: nothing to share, nothing to turn in.

BUILDING FAMILY PEACE

Peace is grown, one exchange at a time

Some seasons the rocks get in the way. The roots find a way around.

The handoff is where we start.



WHY START HERE

The handoff is the riskiest moment

Co-parents are closest to each other and least prepared.

1 LOSING IT WITH EACH OTHER

- Tension at the curb lands on your child's body first
- They read your jaw, your shoulders, the grip on the wheel

2 SENDING THE CHILD WITH A MESSAGE

- “Tell your mom…” “Ask your dad if…”
- The child carries what the adults could not say to each other

The child is not the channel.

From Session 1: it isn't the divorce itself that puts a child's development at risk. It's constant, unregulated family conflict.

BEFORE THE HANDOFF, NOT AFTER

The 60-Second Reset

1. **Feel your feet on the floor.**
2. **Take one or two slow, deliberate breaths.**
3. **Look around. Name three different colors you see.**
4. **Unclench your jaw. Drop your shoulders.**

A pattern interrupt, not a fix. You can only regulate your own nervous system, and that still matters.

HOW A RECIPE IS BUILT

What goes on a recipe card

1 The moment

One specific handoff.

2 The soil

The one or two traits that moment is really running on.

3 What it looks like

What you see, described without a verdict on anyone.

4 What I will say

One or two sentences in the child's language.

5 What I will do

One or two actions, including the reset before the handoff.

6 Instead of a message

How the adults talk to each other, not through your child.

A recipe is a first draft. You taste it, then you adjust.

A MENU TO START FROM

A few handoff moves, trait by trait

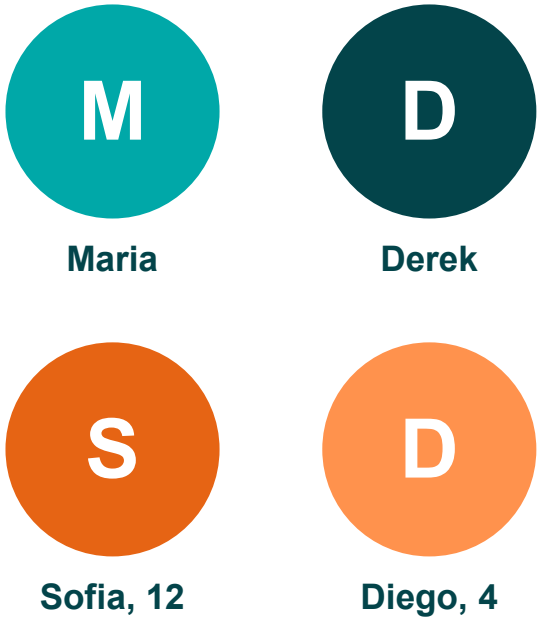
Find your one or two. The full list is in your session notes.

Doesn't adjust easily	Advance notice of any change, a visual schedule, a warning before the transition.
Needs a routine	Same time, same place, same order, every time.
Retreats from new situations	A minute to watch before joining. Arrive a little early, or pause at the curb.
Big emotions	Stay calm and don't match the volume. Save the big conversation for after the handoff.
Constantly wiggly	Give them something to carry, or a walk to the door.
Easily distracted	Cut clutter. One instruction at a time. Keep it short.

WORKED EXAMPLE

Sofia's driveway

- Maria and Derek separated 14 months ago.
- At a Friday handoff, Sofia (12) said she had already asked Dad about a concert Mom had said no to two days earlier.
- Maria and Derek argued in the driveway. Sofia held her ground, arms crossed.
- Diego (4) had a meltdown by the car.



A composite family. Not anyone in this room.

READ THE SOIL

Two children, one handoff

SOFIA, 12

- Needs a routine
- Doesn't adjust easily
- Retreats from new situations
- Tends to have big emotions

Not manipulation. Wiring.

DIEGO, 4

- Easily distracted
- Constantly wiggly

Fine until the room turns tense. Then his body has the reaction his words can't.

Same driveway. Different soil.

LOOK AT THE FIT

Nobody is the weed

MARIA

- Adaptable: her strength
- Lower persistence

SOFIA

- Dug in: low adaptability, high persistence
- Big reactions

DEREK

- Steady and persistent
- A natural lead when things get loud

Sofia's persistence meets Maria's lower persistence: a predictable pressure point, not a flaw in Maria.

Derek's steadiness fits Sofia when things get loud. Maria's adaptability is what she brings to the handoff.

Different plots, different soil.

SOFIA'S RECIPE

A recipe for a smooth transition

Needs a routine | **Doesn't adjust easily** | **Retreats from new situations** | **Big emotions**

Consistency and routine are your family's friend. Sofia may need to know what happens step by step, and you may need to talk about it A LOT before it happens.

> *“Same plan as every Friday. If anything changes, I'll tell you the night before.”*



Preparing

- Lots: visual, verbal and written



Goodbye

- Same 2–3 phrases
- Remind them when you will see them next



Instead of a Message

- A heads-up note between parents the night before
- One answer from both homes

DIEGO'S RECIPE

A recipe for a quick transition

Easily distracted **Constantly wiggly**

Keep it short and sweet. Have things organized and ready to go, and give a wiggly body somewhere to go.

> *“Hey, buddy, your snack is waiting for you in the car. Let's get strapped in and you can pick what you want to have first.”*



Preparing

- Keep it short
- Lists will help



Goodbye

- “Love you!”
- Brief



Instead of a Message

- A love note in the lunch box is great
- Messages for the other parent go parent to parent

THE SECOND TRAP

Give the message a better road

NOT THROUGH YOUR CHILD

“Tell your mom…”
“Ask your dad if…”

The child ends up carrying what the adults could not say to each other.

BETWEEN THE ADULTS

- A standing heads-up channel
- One short note the evening before: “Sofia asked about the concert. I'm holding my answer until we talk.”
- One unified answer from both homes

A short text **A shared calendar** **A standing heads-up channel**

Call it the same-page note.

YOUR TURN

Write one recipe

Private. Nothing to share. Field notes, not a report card.

1. **Describe your typical handoff.**
   What time, where, noisy and public or calm and private? When it works well, why? When it goes poorly, why?

2. **Look at page 1 of your Field Notes.**
   Which one or two traits is that moment running on?

3. **Write what you will say and what you will do.**

4. **Write what you will do instead of sending a message through your child.**

5. **Read it back as if you were your child.**
   Would it feel safe? Does it sound like you are on their side?

BORROWING FROM THE OTHER PLOT

Whose plot grows this best?

Is there something about this handoff where the other parent is the better fit for your child?

If so, don't compete with it. Ask what they do. Their recipe can inform yours.

MARIA ASKS DEREK

“What do you do when Sofia digs in?”

DEREK ASKS MARIA

“What helps Diego settle?”

One recipe across both homes means your child doesn't carry two different answers.



A MOMENT TO PAUSE

Where else would a recipe be handy?

- Bedtime
- Homework
- Screen limits
- Hearing “no”
- Holiday handoffs
- A hard call between the houses

You don't need to write it today. Just name it.

CLOSING

Peace is grown,
one exchange at a time.

When you keep your focus on your child in that moment, you create a bubble of peace and calm, and bubbles grow.

Your family is in a hard season. A recipe is something you can do inside it, today.

Hold it loosely. Try it once, notice what happens, and adjust the seasoning.



WHAT COMES NEXT

Next up: Age Changes Everything

Friday, December 4 · Pre-recorded, watch whenever works for you

What a 6-year-old needs from you versus what a 15-year-old needs.

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Book a consultation: scan the code

It's not about what's fair. It's about what is possible - for you and your kids.